Troubleshooting Failed Payments

Billing and Payments

Fictional training documentation for a local RAG demonstration.

Common causes

A payment can fail because the card expired, the bank declined the transaction, the billing address does not match, the card has insufficient funds, or the payment provider requires additional authentication. CloudDesk support cannot see a customer's full card number.

Recommended checks

Ask the billing administrator to open Settings > Billing > Payment methods and confirm that the saved method is current. Check the bank's notification for a decline reason. If authentication is requested, complete it through the secure payment flow rather than sending card information by email.

Retrying a payment

If the invoice is still Open or Past due, the billing administrator can open the invoice and select Retry payment when that option is available. Do not repeatedly retry a payment that the bank has explicitly blocked. Resolve the bank or payment-method issue first.

Pending transactions

A pending bank transaction does not always mean CloudDesk received the payment. Ask the customer to wait for the payment provider's final status and share a transaction reference if the invoice remains unpaid. Avoid promising an exact settlement time because bank processing varies.

Security

Never ask customers to send full card numbers, CVV codes, passwords, or one-time authentication codes to support. If a customer has already sent sensitive payment information, do not repeat it in a reply; direct them to their bank or payment provider as appropriate.

Escalation

Escalate to Billing Operations if the provider reports a successful charge but the invoice remains unpaid after the provider's status is final. Include organization name, invoice number, transaction reference, and timestamps. Do not include full payment credentials.